

Market Requirements Document (MRD)

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1. Problem Statement

College and high school students juggle assignments, exams, projects, and extracurricular commitments across multiple disconnected systems: learning management systems (Canvas, Blackboard), email, paper planners, and generic to-do apps. Because none of these tools is built around the academic calendar, students lose track of deadlines, underestimate their workload, and resort to last-minute cramming.

Generic productivity tools (Todoist, Google Tasks, Notion) are powerful but require significant setup and are not organized around courses, syllabi, or grading weight. There needs to be a product with a good market fit. Student needs a lightweight, course-aware task manager that takes minutes to set up and makes it impossible to miss deadlines and priorities.

2. Target Audience

- **Primary:** Full-time undergraduate students (ages 18–24) managing 4–6 courses per term with overlapping deadlines. This is the largest and most affected segment.
- **Secondary:** High school upperclassmen (ages 15–18) balancing coursework, standardized test prep, and college applications.
- **Tertiary:** Graduate and part-time students balancing coursework with jobs and family obligations, who need realistic weekly planning more than raw task lists.

Common characteristics: mobile-first habits, low tolerance for setup friction, price-sensitive (free tier expected), and motivated by visible progress and streaks.

3. Market Opportunity

- **Market size:** There are roughly 19.5 million college students in the US (Education Data Initiative, 2025) and over 260 million tertiary students worldwide. The global productivity apps market is valued at USD 11.23 billion (2024) and projected to reach USD 24.79 billion by 2033, a 9.2% CAGR (Fortune Business Insights, 2026).
- **Trends:** Generative AI integration is the defining trend in productivity apps (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, Notion AI), but incumbents target office workers; no player offers AI planning built around courses and academic deadlines.
- **Whitespace:** The student productivity app market is led by general-purpose platforms rather than student-native products, and industry analysis identifies opportunities for specialized vendors targeting underserved niches with differentiated capabilities (Market Intelo, 2026).
- **Timing:** Strong seasonal acquisition windows (back-to-school in August and January) allow low-cost, high-conversion marketing through campus channels and app store features.
- **Monetization:** Freemium model: free core task management, calendar import, and limited AI planning, with a paid tier (~\$3–5/month) for unlimited AI planning, analytics, and grade-weight prioritization.

4. Competitor Analysis

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Our Differentiation
Microsoft To-do	Mature, cross-platform, powerful filters	Generic; no concept of courses, terms, or grade weight	Auto-import of Canvas & Google Calendar deadlines
Google Tasks / Calendar	Free, ubiquitous, integrates with Gmail	Flat lists; weak prioritization; no academic context	Course-aware workload view built on imported deadlines
Notion	Extremely flexible, popular with students	Steep learning curve; multi-hour workspace setup even for experienced users	Five-minute setup, opinionated student workflow
myHomework / iStudiez	Student-focused, class schedules	Dated UX; weak mobile experience; limited free tiers	Modern mobile-first UI and free core features

5. Success Metrics

- **Adoption:** 10,000 registered users within two academic terms of launch.
- **Engagement:** 40% of registered users active weekly during the academic term; average of 5+ tasks created per active user per week.
- **Retention:** 30-day retention of 35% or higher among users who complete onboarding.
- **Outcome:** 70%+ of created tasks marked complete on or before their due date, indicating the app is actually changing behavior.
- **Satisfaction:** App store rating of 4.5+ and Net Promoter Score above 40 in the primary segment.

Metrics follow standard mobile engagement KPIs (active users, retention, feature adoption) as defined in industry practice (Braze, 2025).

Sources:

Hanson, Melanie. "College Enrollment & Student Demographic Statistics." Education Data Initiative, 17 Mar. 2025, <https://educationdata.org/college-enrollment-statistics>.

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Team Braze. "10 Essential Mobile App Metrics and Engagement KPIs (and How to Use Them)." Braze, 11 Nov. 2025, <https://www.braze.com/resources/articles/essential-mobile-app-metrics-formulas>.